

Within this context, it is impossible for them to divulge the sources of this research and the goals pursued, because that could immediately point any possible rivals down the most beneficial avenues. Cover-ups and disinformation (both active as well as passive) would still remain, under this hypothesis, an absolute necessity.

Thus it would appear natural that in the minds of U.S. military leaders, secrecy must be maintained as long as possible.

Only increasing pressure from public opinion, possibly supported by the results of independent researchers, by more or less calculated disclosures, or by a sudden rise in UFO manifestations, might perhaps induce U.S. leaders and persons of authority to change their stance.

It does not seem that we have arrived at that point yet.

Glossary

AFB Air Force Base
EMAA [French] Air Force Chief of Staff
AFOSI Air Force Office of Special Investigation
ENAC [French] National Civil Aviation School
AIAA American Institute of Aeronautics and Astronautics
ESO European Southern Observatory
Airmiss Name of the investigation procedure covering the risks of air collisions
ETCA [French] Central Technical Armaments Institution
ALAT [French] Army Air Corps
FOIA Freedom of Information Act
Blue Book Name of the U.S. Air Force study of UFOs
FUFOR Fund for UFO Research
CCD Charge-coupled device cameras
GAO General Accounting Office
CCOA [French] Air Operations Center
GEPA [French] Aerospace Phenomena Study Group
CDC [French] Control and Detection Center
GEPAN [French] Unidentified Aerospace Phenomena Study Group
CEA [French] Atomic Energy Commission
IHEDN [French] Institute for Advanced National Defense Studies
CEAT Toulouse Aeronautic Test Center
INRA [French] National Institute for Agronomic Research
CFR Council for Foreign Relations
JANAP Joint Army Navy Air Force Publication
CHEAR [French] Center for Advanced Armament Studies
MEGASETI see SETI, which MEGASETI is an expansion of
CHEM [French] Center for Advanced Military Studies
MHD MagnetoHydroDynamics
CIA Central Intelligence Agency
MOD [British] Ministry of Defence
CID [French] Interarmy Defense College
MUFON Mutual UFO Network
CIRVIS Communications Instructions for Reporting Vital Intelligence Sightings
NASA National Aeronautic and Space Administration

CNES [French] National Center for Space Studies
NORAD North American Air Defense
CNRS [French] National Center for Scientific Research (National Space Agency)
NSC National Security Council
CODA [French] Air Defense Operations Center
ONERA [French] National Aerospace Study and Research Office
CONDON Physicist at the University of Colorado who signed the UFO report ordered by the U.S. Air Force
RAF [British] Royal Air Force
CRNA [French] Regional Air Navigation Center
SEPRA [French] Atmospheric Reentry Phenomena Assessment Department
CUFOS Center for UFO Research [sic]
SET Search for ExtraTerrestrial Intelligence
DGA [French] General Delegation for Armaments
SIRPA [French] Armed Forces Information and Public Relations Department
DGAC [French] Civil Aviation Directorate
SPOC [French] Sky Observation Probe System
DIA Defense Intelligence Agency
STRIDA [French] Air Defense Information Processing Center
DICOD [French] Defense Communications Directorate
UAP Unidentified Aerospace Phenomenon
DoD Department of Defense
UAP D Category D Unidentified Aerospace Phenomenon
DoE Department of Energy
UFO Unidentified Flying Object
EBE Extraterrestrial Biological Entity
VL T Very Large Telescope
UFO, Unidentified Flying Object...

Since 1947, the subject has disturbed, fascinated, called out.

Oh how debated, the question has been studied with extreme meticulousness and from many points of view (scientific, technical, aeronautical, strategic, political, religious, media) by a French committee composed of former auditors of the very serious-minded Institut des Hautes Etudes de Défense Nationale [French Institute for Advanced National Defense Studies] and qualified experts from every background, COMETA [Committee for In-Depth Studies].

For the first time, men, some of whom occupy very high positions, have agreed to write a report devoted entirely to the UFO problem in the belief that based on the knowledge that has been acquired to date, sufficient questions of national interest are raised for the Chief of State and the Prime Minister to be provided with this information.

In this report, COMETA studies several unexplained French and foreign UFO cases.

Very well documented, these sightings are often supported by traces on the ground or tracks confirmed by radar. Are these secret terrestrial craft? In some cases, perhaps. Are we in the presence of craft of nonterrestrial origin? This hypothesis cannot be ruled out. If it were to prove correct, it would be loaded with consequences for Defense.